

Say Goodbye to **console.log** in JavaScript



Why Move Beyond `console.log`? 🤔

Using **`console.log`** for everything can lead to messy debugging and unclear outputs, especially in complex applications. By leveraging more specialized console methods, you can:



- 🌟 Highlight critical information.
- 📖 Organize related logs.
- 👁️ Visualize data in a clearer format.

Here are some of the best alternatives 🚀

1

console.info()

- **When to use:** For informational messages that aren't warnings or errors.
- **Result:** Displays the message with an "info" style. 



console.info

```
1 console.info("Data loaded successfully! 🚀");
```

Data loaded successfully! 🚀

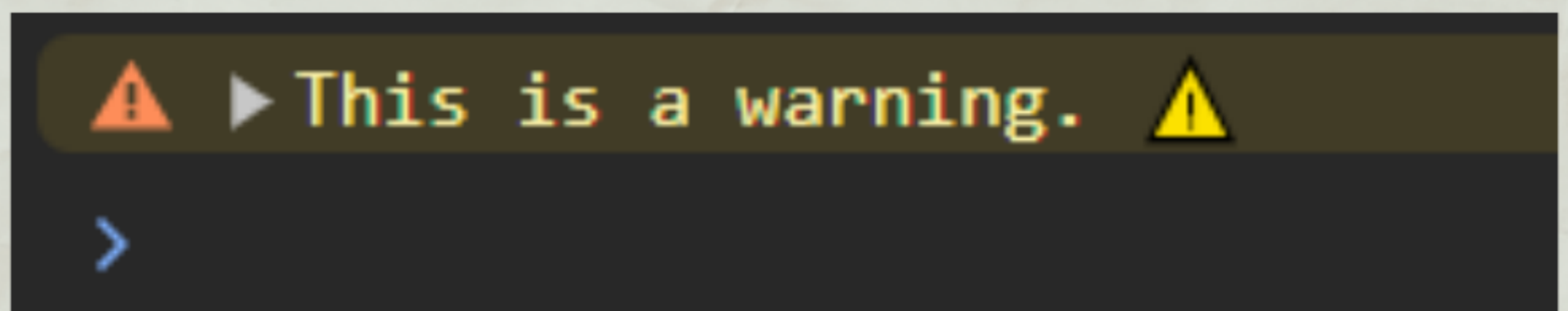
>

2

console.warn() ⚠

- **When to use:** To highlight potential issues that don't require immediate action.
- **Result:** Displays a warning styled with a yellow background or icon in most browsers. ➔

```
console.warn  
1 console.warn("This is a warning ⚠");
```



3

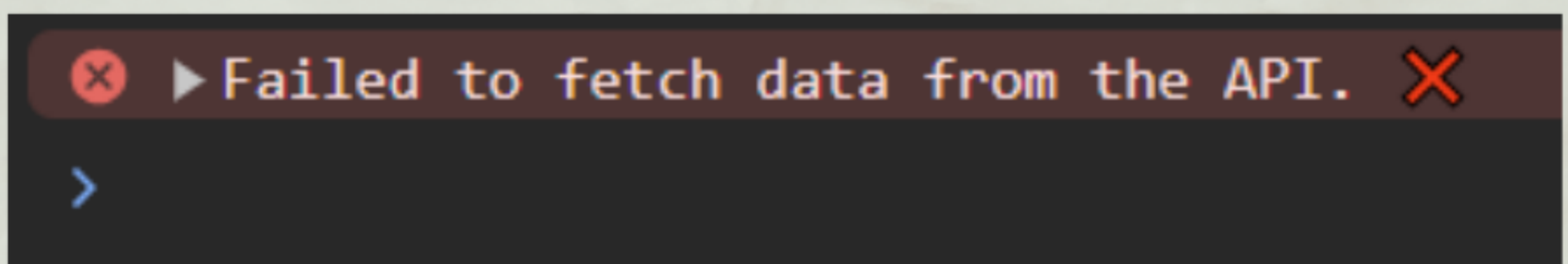
console.error() ✖

- **When to use:** For logging critical errors that need immediate attention.
- **Result:** Displays an error styled with a red background or icon.



```
console.error
```

```
1 console.error("Failed to fetch data from the  
API. ✖");
```



4

console.table()

- **When to use:** For displaying tabular data (arrays or objects) in an easy-to-read table format.
- **Result:** Renders a table in the console with rows and columns. 

```
console.table

1 const users = [
2   { id: 1, name: "Alice", role: "Admin" },
3   { id: 2, name: "Bob", role: "User" },
4 ];
5 console.table(users);
```

script.js:9

(index)	id	name	role
0	1	'Alice'	'Admin'
1	2	'Bob'	'User'

► Array(2)

>

5

console.dir() 🔍

- **When to use:** To inspect JavaScript objects or DOM elements.
- **Result:** Displays an expandable tree structure.



```
console.dir

1  const element = document.querySelector("#app");
2  console.dir(element);
```

```
> #app
  | children
  | innerHTML
  | classList
  | ...
```


6

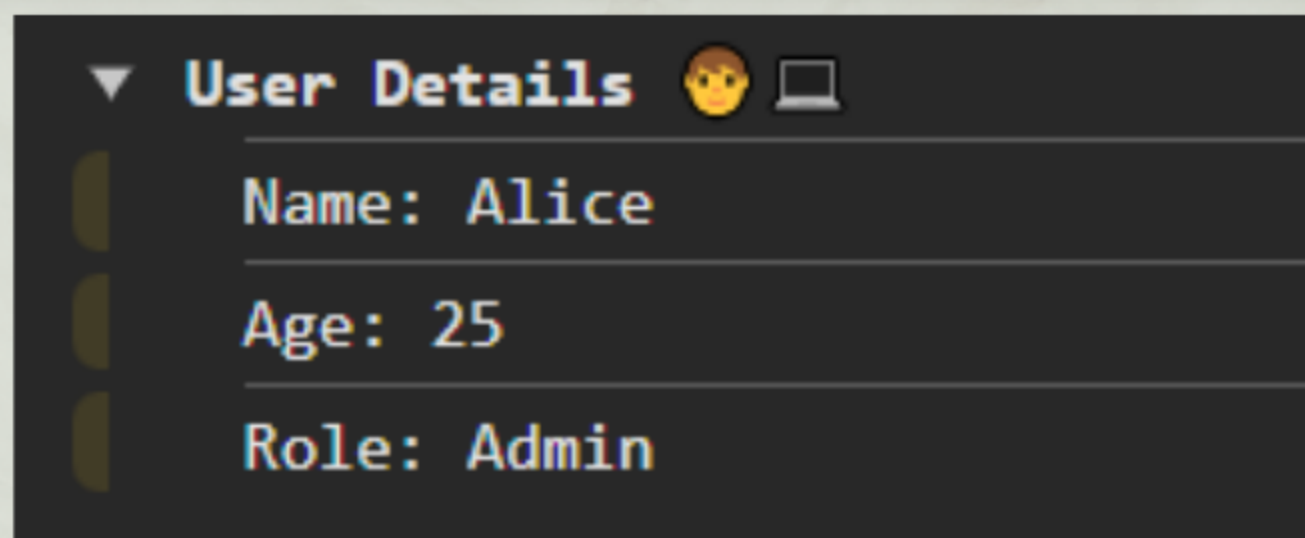
console.group() / console.groupEnd()

- **When to use:** To group related logs together for better organization.
- **Result:** Groups the logs in an expandable/collapsible format.



```
console.group/.groupEnd

1 console.group("User Details 🧑💻");
2 console.log("Name: Alice");
3 console.log("Age: 25");
4 console.log("Role: Admin");
5 console.groupEnd();
```



7

`console.time()` / `console.timeEnd()` 🕒

- **When to use:** To measure the execution time of code blocks.
- **Result:** Displays the time taken in milliseconds.



```
console.time/.timeEnd

1 console.time("API Fetch 🕒");
2 setTimeout(() => {
3   console.timeEnd("API Fetch 🕒");
4 }, 2000);
```

API Fetch 🕒 : 2002.908935546875 ms



8

debugger

- **When to use:** To pause code execution and inspect variables interactively.
- **Result:** Opens the browser's debugger tool and pauses code execution.



```
debugger

1  const data = fetchData();
2  debugger; // Opens the browser's debugger tool.
3  processData(data);
```

Execution pauses, allowing you to step through the code in your browser's developer tools.

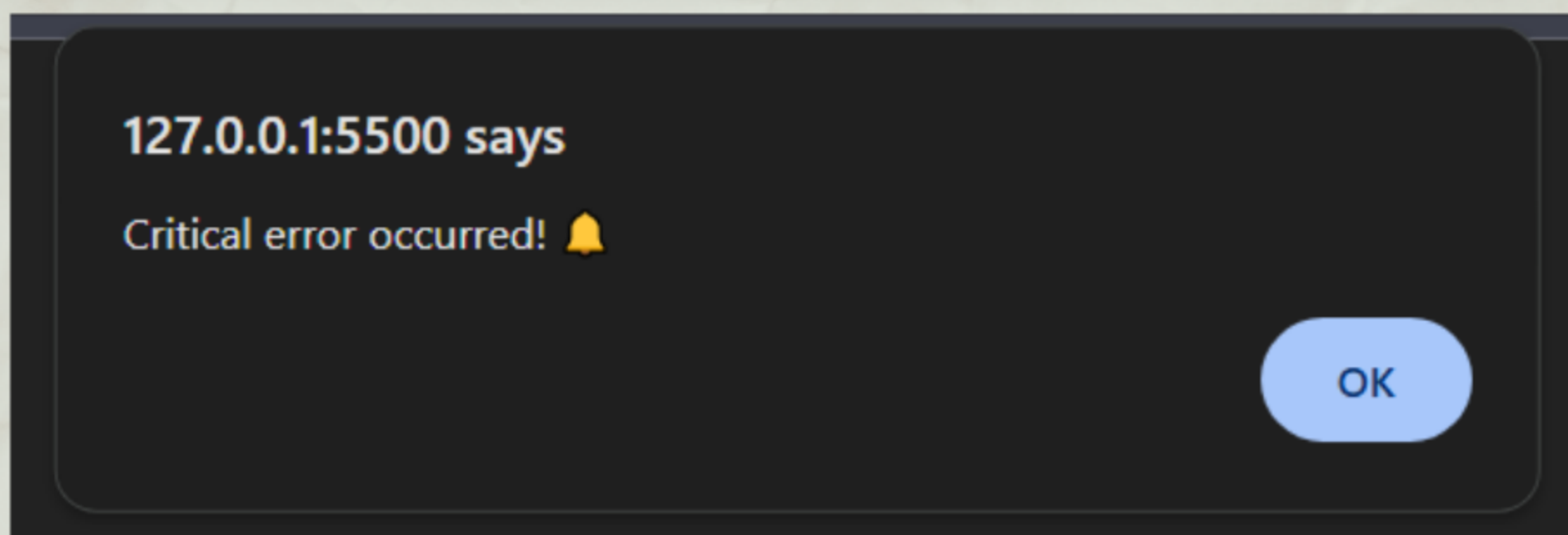
9

alert() for Critical Messages

- **When to use:** To notify users of important updates during development.
- **Result:** Displays a pop-up alert message.



```
alert
1 alert("Critical error occurred! 
```



Wrapping It All Up



While **console.log** is a reliable go-to tool, these alternatives can make your debugging process more effective and insightful. By choosing the right method for the right task, you'll:



-  Save time during debugging.
-  Keep your logs organized.
-  Improve collaboration with your team.

Next time you're debugging or logging, try out one of these methods!